Ji Cheng (Jessie) Chan

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Dear McKinsey recruiting team,

I am applying for the Associate role in your Growth, Marketing & Sales Practice.

Earlier this year, I left a full-time role as a performance marketer at Malaberg to join Blockchain.com as a growth marketing intern. I wanted to move into financial services and digital assets, and I was willing to take a step back in title to learn the industry from the inside. The internship taught me more than I expected. I learnt that the first answer to a growth problem is rarely the right one, that the real pain point is often hidden, and that AI can turn what looks like a resource problem into a new way of working. The work I enjoyed most was shaped like a project, with a clear problem, a team across functions and a recommendation at the end. That is what draws me to strategy consulting.

I start by understanding the pain point before deciding on a solution, which is how your teams form and test hypotheses with clients. Users were dropping off our perps product, and before trying any fix, I wanted to understand why they left. I designed research with 114 active, inactive and churned users and found that many did not understand how perps work or what the risks are. I took the findings to Product, and we made the product and risk explainer always visible and reworked the help page. Retention grew by 12%. I also learnt that one answer rarely fits every market, since our users in Africa tend to take on more risk while users in the UK are more balanced, so we tailored content by region.

I look for innovative solutions, and AI is often where I find them. Our ads relied on real creators, whose videos were expensive and ran out fast, and on TikTok an ad only lasts about two weeks. The team needed a steady supply of new creative without the cost. I spotted competitors running AI-generated UGC ads, proposed we build our own, and built the workflow in 2 weeks. It cut production time by 75%, lifted click-through rate from 0.4% to 1.15%, cut paid social cost per install from $25 to $6, and drove 600+ installs in the first 7 days of our yield product relaunch. The first version relied on me to write the prompts, so I built a skill that generates them and handed the workflow to the team, because a project that cannot be replicated at scale is not a good project. I also built automated reporting with Claude Code and MCP connectors, now a company-wide dashboard that cuts reporting time by about 10 hours a month.

I like owning a project from the first question to the result, which is how your engagements run. Our loans product had never been marketed in Malaysia, and there was no process for a new market. On my own initiative, I researched the local regulations, worked with Legal to set up a compliance review process, set the positioning, and chose KOL, affiliate and referral partners to take it to market. We converted 4 high net worth clients within the first month. On the analytical side, I scaled our Apple Search Ads from 2 to 26 countries through 128 structured experiments, and daily installs grew about 4x while cost per install stayed flat.

What attracts me most is the nature of the role. Every engagement is a new problem in a new industry, solved by a small team that has to understand the client's pain point quickly and find a better way forward. I want to do that work across sectors, and the apprenticeship culture you describe is the fastest way I know to get better at it.

Kind regards,

Jessie Chan